Reading Comprehension: Non-Fiction

Year 4 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Retrieval & Fact vs Opinion: Extract: 'The Amazon rainforest produces about 20% of the world's oxygen, and in my view, it is the most precious place on Earth.' Which part of this sentence is an opinion?

Answer: 'it is the most precious place on Earth' is an opinion (signalled by 'in my view'); the statement about 20% of oxygen is a fact.

Purpose & Tone: Extract: 'Save water, save the planet — every drop counts! Turn off the tap while you brush your teeth.' What is the purpose and tone of this extract?

Answer: Purpose: persuasive, encouraging readers to save water; Tone: urgent and encouraging.

Persuasive Techniques: Extract: 'Don't miss out — this incredible offer won't last!' Identify one persuasive technique used here.

Answer: Exaggeration and urgency ('incredible offer', 'won't last') are used to create a sense of urgency and encourage quick action.

Retrieval & Fact vs Opinion (15 questions)

1. Extract: 'Mount Kilimanjaro is the tallest mountain in Africa, standing at 5,895 metres above sea level. It is a dormant volcano located in Tanzania and attracts thousands of climbers every year.' According to the extract, how tall is Mount Kilimanjaro?
2. In the Kilimanjaro extract, in which country is the mountain located?
3. Which of the following sentences would be a FACT rather than an opinion if added to the Kilimanjaro extract? A) 'Mount Kilimanjaro is the tallest mountain in Africa.' B) 'Climbing Kilimanjaro is the most wonderful experience in the world.' C) 'Kilimanjaro is more beautiful than any other mountain.' D) 'Everyone should climb Kilimanjaro at least once.' E) 'Kilimanjaro is the best holiday destination.'
4. Extract: 'Recycling one aluminium can saves enough energy to power a television for three hours. Despite this, nearly half of all cans are still thrown away instead of recycled — which, in my opinion, is a shocking waste.' According to the extract, how much energy does recycling one can save?
5. In the recycling extract, what proportion of cans are still thrown away instead of recycled?
6. In the recycling extract, which phrase signals that a statement is the writer's opinion rather than a fact? A) 'in my opinion' B) 'one aluminium can' C) 'three hours' D) 'nearly half' E) 'thrown away'
7. Extract: 'Honeybees are responsible for pollinating around one third of the food crops humans eat. A single bee colony can contain up to 60,000 bees during peak summer months.' According to the extract, what proportion of food crops do honeybees help to pollinate?
8. In the bee extract, how many bees can a single colony contain during peak summer?
9. Select ALL that apply, based on the bee extract: which statements are FACTS stated in the extract (not opinions)? A) Honeybees pollinate around a third of food crops. B) A colony can contain up to 60,000 bees in summer. C) Bees are the most important insect on Earth. D) Honeybees are the hardest-working insects. E) Peak summer months see the largest colony sizes.

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10. Extract: 'The Great Wall of China stretches for over 21,000 kilometres when all its branches and sections are included. Construction began over 2,000 years ago and continued across several dynasties.' According to the extract, how long is the Great Wall including all its branches?

11. In the Great Wall extract, when did construction begin?

12. Which of these would be considered an OPINION if added to the Great Wall extract? A) 'The Great Wall is the most impressive structure ever built.' B) 'The wall stretches over 21,000 kilometres.' C) 'Construction began over 2,000 years ago.' D) 'Several dynasties contributed to its construction.' E) 'The wall is located in China.'

13. Extract: 'Experts recommend that children aged 9 to 11 get between 9 and 11 hours of sleep each night. Lack of sleep can affect concentration, mood, and memory.' According to the extract, how many hours of sleep is recommended for children aged 9 to 11?

14. In the sleep extract, name two things, according to the extract, that can be affected by lack of sleep.

15. Is the statement 'children aged 9 to 11 get between 9 and 11 hours of sleep each night' a fact or an opinion, as it is presented in the extract? A) A fact, since it is based on expert recommendations B) An opinion, since it is just the writer's feeling C) Neither a fact nor an opinion D) A fact, but only because it mentions a number E) An opinion, because it mentions children

Purpose, Audience & Main Idea (15 questions)

1. Extract: 'Is your child struggling to find clean, ironed clothes every morning? Our new wrinkle-free school uniform range means no more ironing, no more stress — just a smarter start to the school day!' What is the main purpose of this extract?

2. Who is the school uniform extract most likely aimed at? A) Parents of school-age children B) Retired people C) Toddlers D) Teachers only E) Scientists

3. Describe the tone of the school uniform extract.

4. Extract: 'The Natural History Gallery is open daily from 10 am to 5 pm. Visitors can explore exhibits on dinosaurs, space, and the human body across three floors.' What is the main purpose of this extract?

5. Describe the tone of the museum extract.

6. What is the main idea of the museum extract? A) It gives practical information about visiting the Natural History Gallery B) It argues that dinosaurs are extinct C) It persuades readers to become scientists D) It criticises the museum's opening hours E) It describes a visitor's personal opinion of the gallery

7. Extract: 'Some people believe homework helps pupils practise what they have learned at school. Others argue it takes up time that could be spent on hobbies, sport or rest. Both views have some merit.' What is the main purpose of this extract?

8. What is the tone of the homework extract? A) Balanced and even-handed B) Angrily one-sided C) Mocking D) Purely celebratory E) Frightened

9. What is the main idea of the homework extract?

10. Extract: 'Every day, children just like yours go without clean drinking water. A small donation from you could provide a family with safe water for an entire month. Please, give what you can today.' What is the main purpose of this extract?

11. Who is the water charity extract most likely aimed at?

12. Select ALL that apply, based on the water charity extract: which techniques or features are used to achieve its purpose? A) Direct address to the reader ('yours', 'you') B) An emotive comparison ('children just like yours') C) A direct request for action ('Please, give what you can today') D) A table of statistics E) A joke to lighten the mood

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13. Extract: 'First, preheat the oven to 180°C. Then mix the flour and sugar in a large bowl before adding the eggs one at a time, stirring continuously.' What is the main purpose of this extract?

14. Describe the tone of the recipe extract.

15. What text structure does the recipe extract use? A) Chronological/sequential steps B) Comparison of two ideas C) Cause and effect only D) A persuasive argument E) A personal anecdote

Persuasive Techniques & Inference (15 questions)

1. Extract: 'Isn't it time we acted to save our oceans?' Identify the persuasive technique used in this sentence.

2. Extract: 'Nine out of ten dentists recommend this toothpaste.' Which technique is used here? A) A rhetorical question B) A statistic/expert opinion C) A rule of three D) Onomatopoeia

3. Extract: 'This phone is the fastest, strongest and most reliable ever made.' Identify the 'rule of three' used in this extract.

4. Extract: 'Residents are furious about the library closure.' Identify the emotive language used and explain its effect.

5. Extract: 'Join the millions who already trust us. Don't miss out!' Select ALL the persuasive techniques used: A) Bandwagon appeal B) A rhetorical question C) A sense of urgency D) A direct quotation from a scientist

6. Extract: 'Just £2 could save a life.' What technique makes the donation seem small, and what effect is this meant to have?

7. Extract: 'Scientists SHOCKED by this discovery!' What is the effect of writing 'SHOCKED' in capital letters? A) It exaggerates the reaction to grab the reader's attention B) It proves the discovery is true C) It makes the sentence a question D) It has no effect on the reader

8. Extract: 'Wouldn't you rather be safe than sorry?' What technique is this question, and what is it encouraging the reader to think?

9. Extract: 'Discover paradise — before everyone else does!' What technique creates a sense of urgency here?

10. Extract: 'This cream is clinically proven to work. Thousands of happy customers agree!' Select ALL the techniques used: A) A statistic/claim of proof B) Bandwagon appeal C) A rhetorical question D) Onomatopoeia

11. Extract: 'Our rivers are drowning in litter.' Identify the emotive language used and explain its effect.

12. Extract: 'Why pay more for less?' What technique is used in this sentence? A) A rhetorical question B) A statistic C) A direct quotation D) Alliteration

13. Extract: 'Our broadband is faster, cheaper and more reliable than the rest.' Identify the persuasive technique shown here.

14. Extract: 'Act now, before it's too late.' What effect does this phrase have on the reader?

15. Extract: 'Thousands of satisfied customers can't be wrong.' Explain why using popularity like this doesn't actually prove a product works.

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